various times and with varying success to construct a normalization dialogue.

The US objectives were very clear: 'Provide enough support to Pakistan to maintain an active Pakistani involvement in Afghan policy and ensure the stability of a key partner in South and Southwest Asia and thus weaken Soviet influence in the region.'

In those troubling times, the shadowy war unleashed by the CIA on Indian soil was intense. A story on the CIA's activities that appeared in the Washington Post in November 1979 triggered a political storm. The newspaper report, citing the biography of former spy chief Richard Helms, suggested that the CIA had planted an informer in Indira Gandhi's cabinet during the 1971 war to liberate Bangladesh. In August 1971, continued the report, this informer in Gandhi's cabinet told the CIA that the Soviet Union had signed a friendship treaty with India to forestall the Indian recognition of Bangladesh. The cabinet member—a CIA recruit—had told the American spy agency that the Indians planned to extend the war to West Pakistan. The news report, citing excerpts from the book, further said that the

CIA was very upset by intelligence leaks about the mole at the heart of Indian government and their displeasure was made known to officials in the executive branch.

In 1983, a CIA spy working under the cover of a policy planning officer in New Delhi was found recruiting four Indians: three former military officers and a civilian. India didn't want to make a fuss so he was quietly asked to leave the country. To counter foreign agents, the IB was authorised by the government to conduct operations, including searches and arrests, with the help of law enforcement agencies. In